

# From a model to a measurement.

Every term you will hear today, defined for someone arriving cold. Yesterday you ran a model. Today you defend a number. Keep this open beside the slides.

## THE ONE TO MEMORIZE · COHEN'S KAPPA

**Cohen's kappa** is the single best one-number summary of how well your model agrees with a human coder. Plain accuracy flatters you, because two coders labeling at random would still agree some of the time by luck. Kappa subtracts that luck. It takes the agreement you **observed**, removes the agreement you would **expect by chance**, and rescales so 1.0 is perfect and 0 is no better than guessing. Report it on your thirty-paragraph gold set and your methods reviewer will recognize it on sight.

$$\kappa = \frac{p_o - p_e}{1 - p_e}$$

$p_o$  observed agreement, the share of paragraphs where model and coder match.

$p_e$  agreement expected by chance, summed over classes from each side's label shares.

**OBSERVED**

Model and coder give the same score on 22 of 30 paragraphs. Raw accuracy is 0.73.

**EXPECTED BY CHANCE**

Given each side's class shares, luck alone would land about 0.41 of them.

**KAPPA**

$(0.73 - 0.41) / (1 - 0.41) = 0.54$ . Moderate. 0.6+ is substantial, 0.8+ almost perfect.

## THE BIG IDEA

- Measurement**  
Assigning numbers to cases in a defensible way. A demo just classifies. A measurement can be defended to a reviewer.
- Validity**  
The number tracks the concept it claims to. "Stance on climate" must not quietly become "general positivity."
- Reliability**  
Re-running on the same input gives the same answer. Two coders on one paragraph reach the same score.
- Comparability**  
Scores line up across countries and years with no drift introduced by the model itself.
- Proxy**  
A measurable stand-in for a concept you cannot observe directly. Your new CSV column is a proxy.

## THE CORPUS & THE RUN

- Stratified sample**  
A sample drawn to keep balanced coverage, here across years, so a temporal trend is not distorted.
- Context window** *512 tokens*  
The most tokens a model reads at once. DeBERTa's is 512, roughly 350 to 400 words.
- Truncation**  
Cutting each text to the first 512 tokens before scoring. Document the choice in your appendix.
- Batch** *batch size*  
How many texts the GPU scores at once. Sixteen here. Larger batches run faster on a T4.

## ROLLING SCORES UP

- Aggregation**  
Combining speech-level scores into a country-year number. The choice is never neutral.
- Mean probability**  
Average the supportive-class probability across speeches. Keeps the continuous signal.
- Share supportive**  
The fraction of speeches whose top label is supportive. Simpler, and it discards the probability.
- Top-K**  
Keep only the most extreme K speeches per country-year. K is a hyper-parameter. Validate it against the gold set.
- Sink label**  
The third "does not discuss climate" option. It absorbs off-topic speeches so they do not contaminate the proxy.

## THE GOLD SET

- Gold set** *hand-coded*  
The paragraphs you label by hand. The answer key you grade the model against. Thirty is the sweet spot.
- Codebook**  
The written rules you fix before coding. Ours is three operational, disjoint, testable rules.
- Inter-coder agreement**  
How often two human coders give the same paragraph the same score. Your human ceiling.
- Class balance**  
How many cases fall in each label. Print it so a lopsided sample does not fool the accuracy.
- Random seed**  
A fixed number that makes a random draw repeat exactly. We use seed 7 so the sample is reproducible.

## GRADING THE MODEL

- Confusion matrix**  
A table of model labels against gold labels. The diagonal is agreement, off-diagonal cells are the mistakes.
- Accuracy**  
Share of paragraphs the model got right. It can mislead when the classes are imbalanced.
- Weighted F1**  
Accuracy's more honest cousin. Balances precision and recall, then weights by class size.
- Cohen's kappa**  
Agreement corrected for chance. Day 2's headline number. 0.4 to 0.6 is moderate.
- Pearson r**  
Correlation between the supportive probability and the gold score. High r means sensible probabilities even when the label is wrong.
- Spearman rho**  
The rank version of r. Robust to outliers and monotone shifts. Report both.
- Calibration**  
Whether a 0.9 score really means about 90 percent likely right. Inspect the probability histogram.

## COMPARABILITY CHECKS

- Subgroup table**  
Kappa and accuracy computed separately by era and by region.
- Drift**  
Performance that shifts across subgroups. A swing above 0.15 in kappa flags a comparability problem.
- Face-validity check**  
Plotting the measure against a known event, the Paris Agreement here, to see if it behaves sensibly.

## BEATING THE CEILING

- Off-the-shelf ceiling**  
The best kappa a generic zero-shot model reaches with no training. Often 0.4 to 0.7 on this corpus.
- Few-shot fine-tuning**  
Teaching a model your specific task from a handful of labeled examples.
- SetFit**  
A method that fine-tunes a sentence embedder with contrastive pairs. Learns from as few as eight examples per class.
- Cross-encoder**  
Reads your text and your label together and judges entailment. The DeBERTa-NLI setup. It never learns your task.
- Bi-encoder**  
Turns each text on its own into one embedding vector. What a sentence-transformer is, and what SetFit fine-tunes.
- Contrastive learning**  
Training that pulls same-label vectors closer together and pushes different-label ones apart.
- Train / test split**  
Holding back part of your labels to score the fine-tune honestly. Two thirds to train, one third held out.
- Hypothesis ensembling**  
Averaging several worded versions of one label. Needs no training data. Lifts kappa about 0.05 to 0.10.
- Full fine-tuning**  
Hand-code 300 paragraphs and train a DeBERTa head. Lifts kappa 0.10 to 0.20 at a week's cost.

## REPRODUCIBILITY & THE APPENDIX

- Model ID**  
A model's permanent Hugging Face name with a version pin, e.g. `MoritzLaurer/DeBERTa-v3-base-mnli-fever-anli`.
- Sidecar file**  
A small text file shipped beside the CSV that records the exact candidate-label list.
- Replication package**  
The notebook, the gold-set CSV, and the data pointer a reviewer needs to rerun you.
- Validation appendix**  
Where the codebook, kappa, confusion matrix, and subgroup table all live.
- Limitations**  
Where truncation, label wording, and translation drift each get an honest paragraph.